

EXECUTIVE

Uruguay Economic Profile, 2024-2025

A World Bank-based executive view of growth, external balances, fiscal dynamics, and social indicators

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Executive overview

Uruguay enters 2024 with a larger economy and firmer growth than in the previous year. GDP reached US\$ 80.96B in 2024, up from US\$ 77.99B in 2023, while GDP growth accelerated to 3.11% from 0.74%. GDP per capita also rose to 23,907, and GNI per capita increased to 21,650, reinforcing the picture of a high-income economy with improving near-term momentum.

The broader profile remains balanced but not without pressure points. Inflation eased to 4.85% in 2024 from 5.87% in 2023, yet domestic demand still dominates output, with final consumption expenditure at 79% of GDP. Investment softened to 16% of GDP, and the current account remained slightly negative at -1% of GDP. These figures suggest stabilization rather than a strong cyclical upswing.

The social and digital indicators remain comparatively strong. Life expectancy stood at 78.287 years in 2024, internet use reached 91.99109007% of the population, and mobile cellular subscriptions were 145.501755749445 per 100 people. Poverty and inequality indicators are lower than in many regional peers, but they remain material in absolute terms, which keeps distributional outcomes relevant to the macro story.

Official Indicators

Recent Official Indicators World Bank Indicator Series World Bank Indicator Series 001:
AG.PRD.CREL.MT leads with 4116826 Source: World Bank API - Indicators.

Indicadores oficiales recientes

Indicator Code	Indicator Name	Indicator Group	Latest Value	Latest Year	Trend Note
NY.GDP.MKTP.CD	GDP (current US\$)	macro	US\$ 80.96 mil millones	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
NY.GDP.MKTP.KD.ZG	GDP growth (annual %)	macro	3.11%	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
NY.GDP.PCAP.CD	GDP per capita (current US\$)	macro	23,907	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
NY.GNP.PCAP.CD	GNI per capita, Atlas method (current US\$)	macro	21,650	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
FP.CPI.TOTL.ZG	Inflation, consumer prices (annual %)	prices	4.85%	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
NE.CON.TOTL.ZS	Final consumption expenditure (% of GDP)	demand	79	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.

Indicator Code	Indicator Name	Indicator Group	Latest Value	Latest Year	Trend Note
NE.GDI.TOTL.ZS	Gross capital formation (% of GDP)	demand	16	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
NV.AGR.TOTL.ZS	Agriculture, forestry, and fishing, value added (% of GDP)	structure	6	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
NV.IND.TOTL.ZS	Industry (including construction), value added (% of GDP)	structure	17	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
NV.SRV.TOTL.ZS	Services, value added (% of GDP)	structure	65	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
NE.EXP.GNFS.ZS	Exports of goods and services (% of GDP)	external	29	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
NE.IMP.GNFS.ZS	Imports of goods and services (% of GDP)	external	24	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
BN.CAB.XOKA.GD.ZS	Current account balance (% of GDP)	external	-1	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
BX.KLT.DINV.WD.GD.ZS	Foreign direct investment, net inflows (% of GDP)	external	-5	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.

Indicator Code	Indicator Name	Indicator Group	Latest Value	Latest Year	Trend Note
GC.DOD.TOTL.GD.ZS	Central government debt, total (% of GDP)	fiscal	66	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
GC.REV.XGRT.GD.ZS	Revenue, excluding grants (% of GDP)	fiscal	31	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
SL.UEM.TOTL.ZS	Unemployment , total (% of total labor force) (modeled ILO estimate)	labor	8	2025	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
SL.TLF.CACT.ZS	Labor force participation rate, total (% of total population ages 15+) (modeled ILO estimate)	labor	65	2025	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
SL.EMP.TOTL.SP.ZS	Employment to population ratio, 15+, total (%) (modeled ILO estimate)	labor	60	2025	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
SP.POP.TOTL	Population, total	demographics	3,386,588	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
SP.POP.GROW	Population growth (annual %)	demographics	-0.04%	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
SP.DYN.LE00.IN	Life expectancy at birth, total (years)	demographics	78	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.

Indicator Code	Indicator Name	Indicator Group	Latest Value	Latest Year	Trend Note
SP.DYN.TFRT.IN	Fertility rate, total (births per woman)	demographics	1	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
SI.POV.GINI	Gini index	poverty	40	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
SI.POV.NAHC	Poverty headcount ratio at national poverty lines (% of population)	poverty	17	2024	Recent direction: down versus the previous available observation.
SH.DYN.MORT	Mortality rate, under-5 (per 1,000 live births)	health	7	2024	Recent direction: flat versus the previous available observation.
IT.NET.USER.ZS	Individuals using the Internet (% of population)	infrastructure	92	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
IT.CEL.SETS.P2	Mobile cellular subscriptions (per 100 people)	infrastructure	146	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
AG.PRD.CREL.MT	Cereal production (metric tons)	agriculture	4,116,826	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.
FS.AST.PRVT.GD.ZS	Domestic credit to private sector (% of GDP)	finance	31	2024	Recent direction: up versus the previous available observation.

Source: World Bank API - Indicators

Growth and domestic demand

Growth improved materially in 2024 after the 2023 slowdown. The rebound in GDP growth to 3.11% came alongside a continued rise in nominal GDP to US\$ 80.96B, extending the post-2020 recovery path. The recent sequence shows a sharp contraction in 2020, followed by growth of 5.84% in 2021, 4.49% in 2022, 0.74% in 2023, and 3.11% in 2024.

Demand remains consumption-led. Final consumption expenditure was 79% of GDP in 2024, while gross capital formation was 16% of GDP, down from 18% in 2023 and 19% in 2022. That mix implies that domestic spending continues to carry the economy, but capital formation has not yet regained the stronger share seen earlier in the cycle.

Per capita income metrics moved higher in 2024, with GDP per capita at 23,907 and GNI per capita at 21,650. Together with the GDP series, these values point to a relatively high-income economy that is expanding, though the underlying demand composition still leans more toward consumption than investment.

Prices and stability

Price pressures moderated in 2024. Inflation fell to 4.85% from 5.87% in 2023, and this marked a continuation of the cooling seen after the 9.1% reading in 2022. The data suggest a more stable price environment than in the earlier part of the period, even if inflation remains above a very low-stability benchmark.

The improvement in inflation is important because it comes without a collapse in activity. Growth strengthened at the same time, which indicates that the economy is not trading off momentum for disinflation in an obvious way. That said, the persistence of consumption-heavy demand and a still-negative current account point to a balance that should be read as steady, not effortless.

For an executive reader, the key signal is that Uruguay looks more stable in 2024 than it did at the height of the inflation spike, but the report evidence does not support calling the inflation problem fully resolved.

Sector mix and external accounts

The production structure remains service-led. Services accounted for 65.2627436197817% of GDP in 2024, industry for 16.7572573016825%, and agriculture for 6.42188821840422%. The composition is stable enough to suggest continuity, not a structural break, with services clearly dominating and industry holding a secondary role.

External exposure is meaningful but manageable in the evidence provided. Exports of goods and services reached 28.7607719167193% of GDP in 2024, while imports were 23.7041448689186%. The current account deficit narrowed to -0.785397211922248% of GDP from -3.04442040614187% in 2023, indicating an improved external balance even though it remained negative.

Foreign direct investment, net inflows, stood at -4.86239476784597% of GDP in 2024, an improvement from -6.72904061401343% in 2023. The series is volatile, including a positive reading in 2022, so the latest year should be read as part of a choppy adjustment rather than a one-directional trend.

Fiscal, labor, and social conditions

Fiscal indicators show a heavier debt position than in earlier years. Central government debt reached 66.4049496784084% of GDP in 2024, up from 62.3670975853084% in 2023 and 54.2372595323111% in 2022. Revenue excluding grants was 31.1107153639719% of GDP, suggesting that the revenue base remained relatively steady even as debt rose.

Labor market conditions remained comparatively stable. Unemployment was 7.516% in 2025, down from 8.209% in 2024 and 8.355% in 2023. Labor force participation held near 65%, and the employment-to-population ratio reached 60.105% in 2025, indicating gradual improvement rather than a sharp labor-market shift.

Social indicators remain solid, though not without room for improvement. The Gini index was 40 in 2024, and the national poverty headcount ratio was 17.3%. Population was 3,386,588 in 2024, with population growth at -0.0440759548302792%, life expectancy at 78.287 years, fertility at 1.397 births per woman, under-5 mortality at 7.4 per 1,000 live births, and internet use at 91.99109007% of the population.

Financial and productive capacity

Domestic credit to the private sector reached 31.0792040544242% of GDP in 2024, which points to a functioning credit channel but not an especially deep one. Combined with the lower investment share, this suggests that financial intermediation is present but not signaling a strong investment-led expansion in the latest data.

Agricultural and food-related capacity remains visible in the evidence, with cereal production at 4,116,826.06 metric tons in 2024. That reading, together with the modest agricultural share of GDP, reinforces the view that Uruguay's economy is diversified but still anchored in a service-heavy structure.

The macro-financial picture is therefore mixed: income levels are high, digital access is strong, and labor conditions are stable, but investment, debt, and external balances still require close reading in any executive assessment.

Sources

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Limitations

- No limitations reported.